

Unwind

Read about AI's that saved the world and Digit Diary where we chronicle daily life at the Digit office.

**Apple Heads?**

Apple seems to be interesting in making your head its next app. Yes. Your head. Read on to know more: <http://digit.in/applhds>



This month we highlight some aspiring tech writers and their spirited attempt to get published in the magazine. Let's have more!

Readers' write-ups



Dileep
Mohanan

Wacom Inkling Review

What does it do?

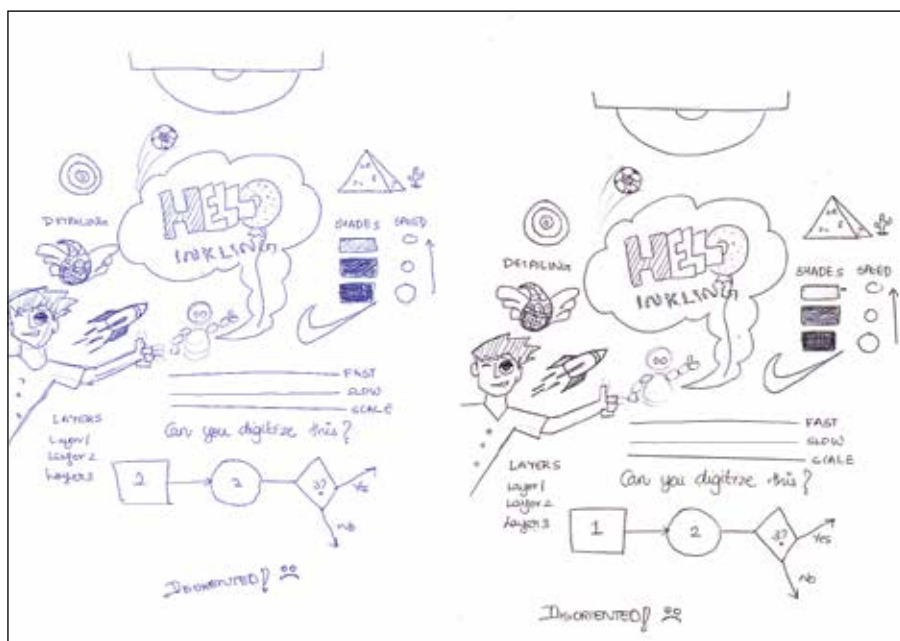
Inkling is an incredible product from Wacom meant to revolutionize the way you sketch – it

digitizes what you sketch while you sketch. It digitizes the sketch from the paper as you sketch it, thus saving those precious hours that you spend trying to recreate the same sketch using a digital tool! Inkling comes in a sleek case with a neat layout to fasten the components – pen, Inkling receiver, USB cable and 4 extra refills. It is, surprisingly, smaller than a pencil box. You can charge the pen and receiver simultaneously by connecting the case to your PC through USB.

How does it work?

To start sketching, you need to firmly clip the receiver to the paper(s) (size A7 to A4). It can be clipped at different positions – top (default), bottom, sides and even corners. The position must match with the orientation that is currently active in the driver software.

When everything is firm and set, start sketching as you would normally. The pen might be uncomfortable to hold due to its size. The pen doesn't have an eraser but Inkling supports Photoshop layers. A hardware button lets you add layers but not move/select them. The software bundled – Sketch Manager lets you browse through your works stored in the device and allows you to export it to many image formats, including Photoshop (while retaining the layers). The device has an internal memory of 2GB. Inkling uses infrared and ultrasonic to



A side-by-side comparison of digital output (L) and actual sketch (R)

achieve this level of accuracy. Hence you need to be careful about a few things. First, you must not block the IR communication between the sensor and pen with your hand, eraser or any other object. Second, direct sunlight will distort the IR, hence it's advised to protect it from direct sunlight – limiting your outdoor sketching. And third, the orientation of the sensor and the option defined in the driver must be the same to avoid any distortion in tracing the pen movement.

Real life performance

Line quality

You have to be swift with the lines. Lines drawn with less pace will have a lot of sketch-marks in its digital version.

Bigger and swiftly drawn lines are better and smoother.

Shading

Inkling's pressure sensitivity is disappointing. All your lines will have the same opacity. The construction lines you make will be visible just like your final render which is a let down.

Amidst all these precautions, the inkling does a wonderful job. The accuracy it provides is pretty decent. Future versions are sure to win some artistic hearts.

Design: 7.5/10; **Features:** 5/10; **Usability:** 7/10; **Overall:** 6.5/10;

Tested In:

OS: Windows 7/8.1 x64, Mac Mountain Lion; **Software:** Adobe Photoshop CS5, Autodesk Sketchbook.

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